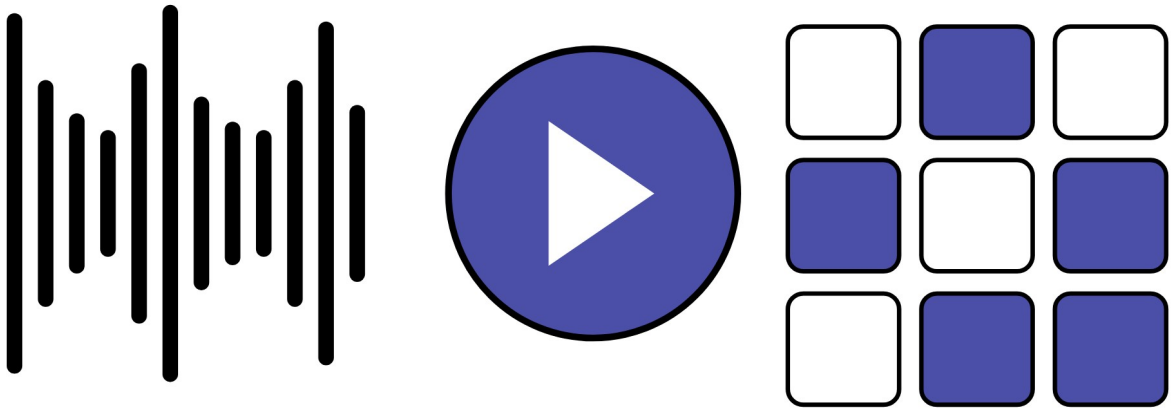
HUDSON BEAT



FREE PLAY

Make whatever you want. Finish it.

THINK: WHAT WOULD YOU MAKE?

IF ANYTHING WERE ALLOWED

Think, then share

Teacher: no audio is needed. Ask the questions aloud and take a few answers.

- If nobody could say no, what would you make?
- What style or sound do you keep coming back to?
- What is one thing you want to try in Logic?

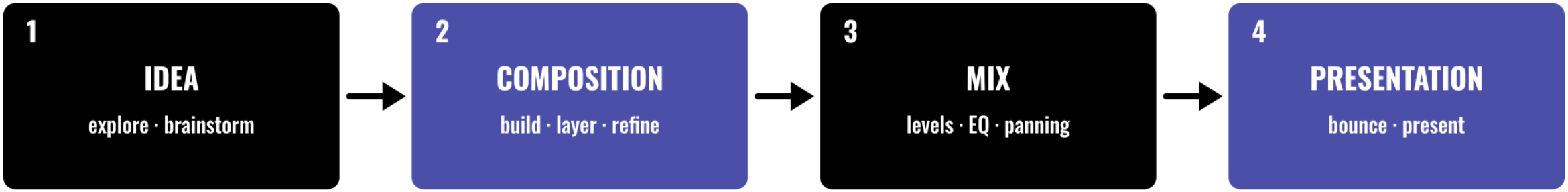
WHAT IS FREE PLAY?

- Any style, technique or idea that excites you
- One rule: have a plan and follow through
- Show you can manage a project from start to finish
- Goal: build confidence in your own creative decisions

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	What would you make? · production cycle · explore · commit early
CLASS 2	Three parts of a proposal · vague or clear · before you submit
CLASS 3	Working day: build, develop, worked example
CLASS 4	Working day: keep building, protect your mix time
CLASS 5	Working day: compose, build, refine
CLASS 6	Mix · bounce · checklist · rubric
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

THE PRODUCTION CYCLE



Idea, composition, mix, presentation: the whole cycle, start to finish

- Idea: explore and brainstorm
- Composition: build and refine
- Mix: balance every track
- Present and get feedback

STEP 1: EXPLORE

1. Open Logic and experiment with sounds
2. Brainstorm ideas
3. Write down two or three, not just one
4. Pick one before the end of class
5. Fill in the Idea sketchpad

COMMIT EARLY

- Get something down early, then refine as you go
- Don't spend 3 days picking sounds
- Ideas can shift while you work
- Stuck? Listen to music that inspires you

A PROPOSAL HAS THREE PARTS

1 **CONCEPT**
what you are making

2 **TOOLS**
what you will use in Logic

3 **SOUND**
what it will sound like

One paragraph that answers all three, submitted on your class page

- Concept: what it is
- Sound: what it will be like
- Tools: what you will use
- More than one sentence

VAGUE OR CLEAR?

- Vague: “I will make a chill beat.”
- Clear: what it is, which tools, what it sounds like
- Say the tempo, the mood and the instruments
- Name the Logic tools you will use

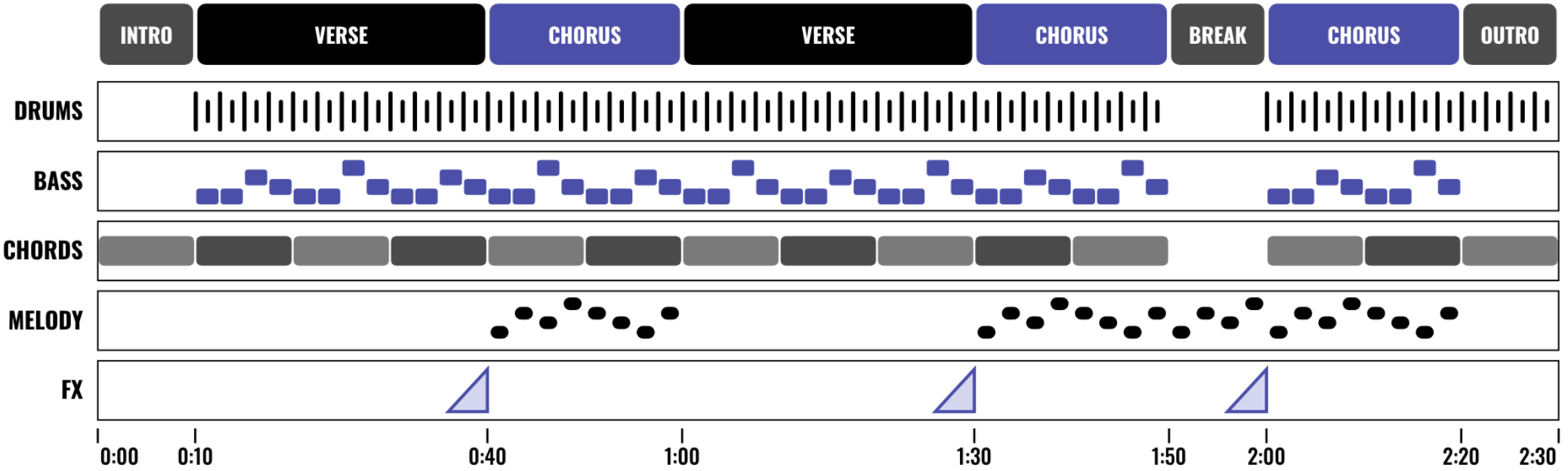
BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- [ ] A concept: what you are making
- [ ] Tools: what you will use in Logic
- [ ] What it will sound like
- [ ] A paragraph, not one sentence
- [ ] Submitted on your class page

STEPS 3 AND 4: BUILD, DEVELOP

- Lay down the foundation: drums, chords, bass
- Begin shaping the arrangement
- Add layers, melodies, FX and transitions
- Refine your sound and structure

WORKED EXAMPLE: 2:30 ON PAPER



- An invented 2:30 piece on paper
- Layers that come and go
- Sections you can name
- Plan it, then follow through

KEEP BUILDING

- Check your track against your proposal
- Add one new thing every class
- Try a transition between sections
- Save a new version before big changes

MIX TIME IS NOT OPTIONAL

- Leave at least one full class for the final mix
- Balance levels, EQ and panning on all tracks
- Listen on headphones AND speakers
- Mixing takes longer than you think

STEPS 5 AND 6: MIX, FINALIZE

1. Balance levels, apply EQ and panning
2. Clean up your project
3. Bounce your final track
4. Prepare your presentation
5. Write your 3 Padlet questions

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Proposal paragraph on your class page
- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Free Play
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

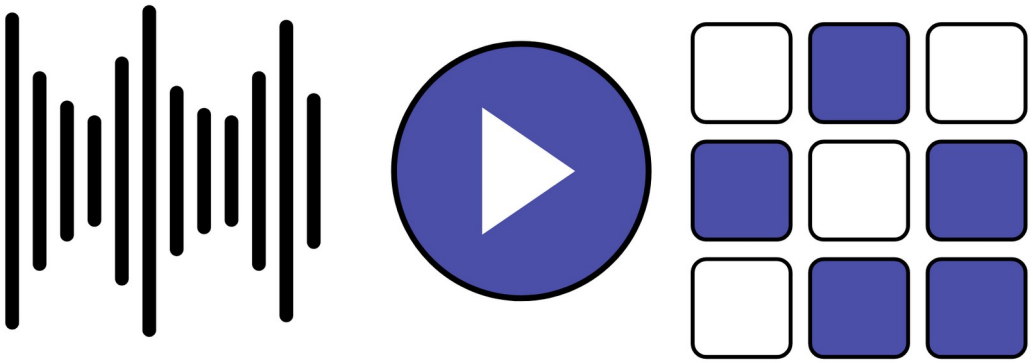
SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your track
- Say what you set out to make, and what changed
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You had a plan.
- You followed through.
- You made it your way.
- Now play it.



REFLECTION · PAGE 21

Write it or talk it through: what went well, what was hard, what you would change.